

What does that mean in layman's terms? It means more billionaires rose from nothing and overcame incredible adversity (such as poverty, homelessness, and early abuse) than those who simply received an inheritance from their parents and lived off it without contributing to the wealth themselves. While approximately half the people on the list inherited *some* money, almost everyone included on the Forbes 400 has actively participated in establishing and growing their own wealth. Apparently, the days of sitting back and coasting on old money are over.

These findings from the Forbes 400 and other third-party studies are backed up by what my team and I uncovered in our own research. Let's go back to something I mentioned in chapter 1. Like I said, 79% of millionaires received no inheritance at all from their parents. That means only 21% of millionaires actually received an inheritance. You know what's interesting about this? The Survey of Consumer Finances by the Federal Reserve reported on the percentage of American households who receive inheritances.⁶ You want to take a guess at what that percentage was? Twenty-one percent. That's right. Millionaires and the general population receive inheritances at the exact same clip. Don't miss this! Millionaires are no more likely to receive an inheritance than their broke neighbor who's living paycheck to paycheck.